

Pamphlet 9

Year 1, Pamphlet 9

1 June 2026

primordia

about Latin and its culture

For previous iterations, refer to
our website at
<https://latin2u.github.io>.

Note

This pamphlet doesn't have a word list, mainly because I must dive into subjunctives, Roman gods and goddesses, and the pluperfect active and passive. Even though there are three things covered this time, this pamphlet will be longer than regular pamphlets, as there are many things to cover. The next word list will be in pamphlet 10, which will also be the last pamphlet of the school year.

The Subjunctive

Note: this is a long article (>5000 characters.)

If the indicative mood was to definitively indicate something and the imperative mood was to command something, then the subjunctive mood does something else, and it does: it hints at the possibility of things being done! Instead of saying "It will take four hours", we can now say "It might take four hours." It might take four hours, or it might not. It's a matter of conditionality and hypotheticals. Although English doesn't use the subjunctive much, it is widely used in Latin, arguably making it one of the most important topics to learn.

That being said, the subjunctive mood has only four tenses: present, imperfect, perfect, and pluperfect. We will cover both the active and the passive voice.

Present Subjunctive ("let them call")

Depending on the conjugation of a verb, there are different ways to conjugate one in the present subjunctive:

Active	1 st conj.	2 nd conj.	3 rd conj.	3 rd -io conj.	4 th conj.
1 st singular.	voc-e-m	rid-ea-m	ignosc-a-m	cupi-a-m	sent-ia-m
2 nd singular.	voc-e-s	rid-ea-s	ignosc-a-s	cupi-a-s	sent-ia-s
3 rd singular.	voc-e-t	rid-ea-t	ignosc-a-t	cupi-a-t	sent-ia-t

1 st plural.	voc-e-mus	rid-ea-mus	ignosc-a-mus	cupi-a-mus	sent-ia-mus
2 nd plural.	voc-e-tis	rid-ea-tis	ignosc-a-tis	cupi-a-tis	sent-ia-tis
3 rd plural.	voc-e-nt	rid-ea-nt	ignosc-a-nt	cupi-a-nt	sent-ia-nt

As you might have noticed already, there is something between the root and the endings.

Those could be remembered (per conjugation) as “We beat all liars”, each word corresponding to the conjugations in order. There are other four-word sentences like “We fear all liars”, “We beat a liar”, and “He feared an iamb”, which all serve the same purpose in the end - where the vowels in each word correspond to the “link” between the stem and the ending for the present subjunctive:

- 1st: “We” ⇒ e
- 2nd: “beat” ⇒ ea
- 3rd: “all” ⇒ a
- 4th: “liars” ⇒ ia

The passive similarly uses this format, but the “m/s/t/mus/tis/nt” endings are modified to the passive ones, “r/ris/tur/mur/mini/ntur”.

Active	1 st conj.	2 nd conj.	3 rd conj.	3 rd -io conj.	4 th conj.
1 st singular.	voc-e-r	rid-ea-r	ignosc-a-r	cupi-a-r	sent-ia-r
2 nd singular.	voc-e-ris	rid-ea-ris	ignosc-a-ris	cupi-a-ris	sent-ia-ris
3 rd singular.	voc-e-tur	rid-ea-tur	ignosc-a-tur	cupi-a-tur	sent-ia-tur
1 st plural.	voc-e-mur	rid-ea-mur	ignosc-a-mur	cupi-a-mur	sent-ia-mur
2 nd plural.	voc-e-mini	rid-ea-mini	ignosc-a-mini	cupi-a-mini	sent-ia-mini
3 rd plural.	voc-e-ntur	rid-ea-ntur	ignosc-a-ntur	cupi-a-ntur	sent-ia-ntur

Imperfect Subjunctive (“he might call”)

	Active	Passive
1 st sing.	vocarem	vocarer
2 nd sing.	vocares	vocareris
3 rd sing.	vocaret	vocaretur
1 st plur.	vocaremus	vocaremur

Luckily, the conjugations of imperfect subjunctive are simpler. Instead of having anything change, the endings are the stem plus “rem/res/ret/remus/retis/rent”

2 nd plur.	vocaretis	vocaremini
3 rd plur.	vocarent	vocarentur

(depending on which person and number you want.

Perfect Subjunctive ("he may have called")

	Active	Passive*
1 st sing.	vocaverim	vocatus sim
2 nd sing.	vocaveris	vocatus sis
3 rd sing.	vocaverit	vocatus sit
1 st plur.	vocaverimus	vocati simus
2 nd plur.	vocaveritis	vocati sitis
3 rd plur.	vocaverint	vocati sint

*I have assumed a masculine gender for this example.

You can change it to vocata/ae for feminine and vocatum/a for neuter.

Similar to the imperfect subjunctive, nothing changes here except the endings, which are "erim, eris, erit, erimus, eritis, erint" attached to the stem of the third principal part (for the active). However, for passive, we now have the perfect passive participle plus the present subjunctive of sum (sim, sis, sit, etc.).

Pluperfect Subjunctive ("he would have called")

	Active	Passive*
1 st sing.	vocavissem	vocata essem
2 nd sing.	vocavisses	vocata esses
3 rd sing.	vocavisset	vocata esset
1 st plur.	vocavissemus	vocatae essemus
2 nd plur.	vocavissetis	vocatae essetis
3 rd plur.	vocavissent	vocatae essent

*I have assumed a feminine gender for this example.

You can change it to vocatus/i for masculine and vocatum/a for neuter.

I haven't covered the pluperfect tense (even in the indicative), but I'll get to that in this pamphlet. For the active, you just need to know that it's composed (for the subjunctive mood) of the stem of the third principal part with the endings "issem, isses, isset, issemus, issetis, issent." And for the passive, it's still the perfect passive participle plus the imperfect subjunctive of sum (essem, esses, esset, etc.)

Now you know how a subjunctive is identified and conjugated, but the more important half is how they're used.

- Possibility: something might happen (should, could, would)
 - *hoc tres horas capere possit* (this might take three hours)
- Wishing: something might happen, wished by the caller, sometimes using the beginning "if only")
 - *utinam discedat* (if only he would leave)
- Purpose clauses: something was done, followed by an explanation and why it was done
 - *venimus ut te videamus* (we come in order to see you)
- Result clauses: something was done, and as a result, something happened
 - *tam aegrotus erat ut nemo eum videre vellent*¹ (he was so sick that no one wanted to see him)
- Indirect questions: someone asking a question that isn't directly asked with a question mark
 - *rogavit ubi esses* (she asked where you were)
 - Direct question: *ubi es?* (where are you?)
- Cum clauses: when/since/although something, something else happens
 - *cum hostes vicissent, milites fugiunt.* (when the enemies won, the soldiers fled.)
- Conditional what-ifs: pretty self-explanatory on the name (if A, then B)
 - *si ad fontem ambulavisses, erravisses* (if you had walked to the fountain, you would have been wrong)

Roman Gods and Goddesses

The Romans were clearly not monotheistic (they didn't like it, especially with the arrival of Christianity); instead, they were pagan. Their gods and goddesses are really much Greek ones with their name changed (well, most of them):

¹ This is the imperfect subjunctive 3rd person plural form of *volo, velle, volui, volitus*. I haven't covered this, as I'm just introducing the subjunctive right now.

Roman name	Greek name	Details
Jupiter / Jove (m.)	Zeus	Heaven, thunder, lightning, gods Known for his many affairs
Neptune (m.)	Poseidon	Sea, earthquakes, tridents
Pluto (m.)	Hades	Underworld, bidents
Juno (f.)	Hera	Marriage
Vesta (f.)	Hestia	Hearth and home (had a group in Rome called the Vestal Virgins)
Ceres (f.)	Demeter	Grain, agriculture (Daughter was Persephone/Proserpina)
Bacchus (m.)	Dionysus	Wine, revelries
Mercury (m.)	Hermes	Messengers
Mars (m.)	Ares	War
Diana (f.)	Artemis	Hunting
Venus (f.)	Aphrodite	Love
Apollo (m.)	Apollo	Music
Minerva (f.)	Athena	War, wisdom
Proserpina (f.)	Persephone	Underworld, grain

m. ⇒ male

f. ⇒ female

Pluperfect (Indicative)

To continue in our cycle, the pluperfect must be discussed. It expresses something that had already been completed before another past action ("I had drank the water", "he had planted the flowers") and it is conjugated easily:

1st singular	amaveram ("I had loved")
2nd singular	amaveras ("you had loved")
3rd singular	amaverat
1st plural	amaveramus
2nd plural	amaveratis

3rd plural	amaverant
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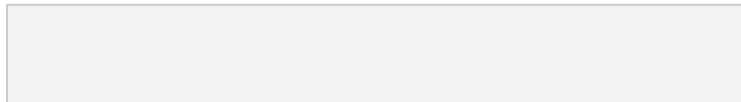
You can notice that each conjugated verb in the example above is in the form of "amav" + the imperfect active of sum, esse, fui, futurus. (For example, "amav" + "eram".) That makes it easy to remember:

- Take the third principal part of a verb's lexical entry:
*audio, audire, **audivi**, auditus*
- Take the root of the principal part (and if conjugating, write six times for 1st, 2nd, 3rd and plural/singular:
audiv___, audiv___, audiv___, audiv___, audiv___, audiv___
- After that, add the imperfect active of *sum*
audiveram, audiveras, audiverat, audiveramus, audiveratis, audiverant

The passive form is also simple: now, take the fourth principal part instead ("amatus" in amo, amare, amavi, amatus²), a space, and add the imperfect active of sum:

1st singular	amatus/a/um eram ("I had been loved")
2nd singular	amatus/a/um eras ("you had been loved")
3rd singular	amatus/a/um erat
1st plural	amati/ae/a eramus
2nd plural	amati/ae/a eratis
3rd plural	amati/ae/a erant

And that's it!



² You might see it as "amatum" in some places. Those are just different genders. Here, for each pamphlet, the writer has used the masculine gender for each lexical entry written. (That was how they knew them in the first place.)